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6B TUESDAY, JANUARY 12, 1999, THE HERALD

FOR YOUR INFORMATION

A DAILY LOOK AT WHAT'S GOING ON IN YOUR COMMUNITY

The For Your Information column appears every day in The Herald's Broward section. You'll find classes, clubs, programs for senior citizens and children, and community entertainment events.

On Fridays, Broward's Weekend section features comprehensive listings of the coming weekend's entertainment events and a look at what's ahead.

WHAT'S HAPPENING TODAY

CIVIC GROUPS

American Civil Liberties Union: Broward Chapter election of officers and board of directors; 7:30 p.m.; Ron Cochran Public Safety Building, 2001 W. Broward Blvd., near FORT LAUDERDALE; radio talk show host Norman Kent is guest speaker; 954-475-5403.

Hallandale Democratic Club: Meets 7 p.m.; Hallandale Community Center behind City Hall, 410 SE Third St., HALLANDALE; 954-884-4114.

Southeast Broward Republican Club: Monthly meeting; 7 p.m.; Hollywood Beach Culture and Community Center, 1301 S. Ocean Dr., HOLLYWOOD; 954-457-9879.

CLASSES

Choosing a college: Free lecture for students, parents; guidance counselor Debra Lifton discusses standardized exams, financial aid, scholarship searches, making decisions early; 7:30 p.m.; David Posnack Jewish Community Center, 5850 S. Pine Island Rd., DAVIE; 954-434-0499.

Stress management: Stress reduction techniques; 7:30 p.m.; David Posnack Jewish Community Center, 5850 S. Pine Island Rd., DAVIE; free members, $3 nonmembers; 954-434-0499.

CLUBS

Civil War Round Table: South Florida group; 7:30 p.m.; Christ Lutheran Church, 12800 NE Sixth Ave., NORTH MIAMI; 954-761-3982.

Florida Native Plant Society: Broward Chapter; 7:30 p.m.; naturalist Don Burgess will discuss pineland plants; Secret Woods Nature Center, 2701 W. State Road 84; 363-791-1030.

Jewish War Veterans: Regular meeting of Robert K. Franzblau Post 347 and Ladies Auxiliary; 9:30 a.m.; Pembroke Pines Recreation Center, 7400 Pines Blvd., PEMBROKE PINES; 954-431-2909.

Society of Israeli Philatelists: Members meet to buy, sell and trade stamps, exchange information, watch slide programs; 2-4 p.m.; Dania D. Carrie Senior Center, 5000 N. Nob Hill Rd., SUNRISE; 954-742-2299.

FOR SINGLES

Singles Night Out: For ages 30-59; program on finding the right person; 7 p.m.; David Posnack Jewish Community Center, 5850 S. Pine Island Rd., DAVIE; $5 members, $8 nonmembers; 954-434-0499.

ETC.

Hollywood beach concert: Wayne L. Musical Fun Show performs; line dancing, audience participation; 7:30-9 p.m.; Beach Theater, Johnson Street at the Broadwalk, HOLLYWOOD; free; 954-921-3400.

COMING UP

BUSINESS

Davie-Cooper City Chamber of Commerce: Annual installation dinner; cocktails 6:30 p.m. Saturday, dinner 7:30 p.m.; Signature Grand, 6800 State Road 84, DAVIE; $60; 954-581-0790.

Greater Dania Chamber of Commerce: Monthly business breakfast meeting; 7:30 a.m. Thursday; Tropical Acres restaurant, 2500 Griffin Rd., DANIA BEACH; $5 members, $8 nonmembers; reservations required; 954-926-2203.

CIVIC GROUPS

Broward County Young Republicans: Social; 6:30 p.m. Wednesday, meeting 7:30 p.m.; Embassy Suites Hotel, 1100 SE 17th St., FORT LAUDERDALE.

Central Broward Water Control District: Board of Commissioners meeting; 7:30 p.m. Wednesday; district office, 8020 Stirling Rd., DAVIE.

Plaza Village Pioneers: 7:30 p.m. Jan. 28; Village Community Center, 6700 SW 19th St., PEMBROKE PINES; 954-987-4718.

CLASSES

Art history: Lecture and slide show series on the fundamentals of understanding art; topics: color, light, form, composition, perspective, painting techniques; 2-3 p.m. Wednesdays starting this week; Art and Culture Center, 1650 Hollywood Blvd., HOLLYWOOD; $15 per lecture, $50 for series of five; 954-921-3274.

History of the Florida Keys: Slide lecture by Jerry Wilkinson, president of the Historical Preservation Society of the Upper Keys; 2-4 p.m. Wednesday; North Regional Library, 1100 Coconut Creek Blvd., COCONUT CREEK; free; 954-969-2901.

FOR KIDS

The Frog Princes: Children's musical presented by Hollywood Playhouse's Imagination Theatre; performances: 11 a.m. and 1 p.m. Saturdays, 11 a.m. Sundays, through Feb. 7; Hollywood Playhouse, 2640 Washington St., HOLLYWOOD; $7 per show; 954-922-0404.

ETC.

Miami Steel and Percussion Orchestra: Music of Carnival; 8 p.m. Thursday; Hollywood Central Performing Arts Center, 1770 Monroe St. (at U.S. 1), HOLLYWOOD; $15 ($10 students and senior citizens, $5 for children 11 and younger); schedule: African Heritage, Feb. 4; World Drum and Percussion II, April 29; South Florida Composers, May 13; 954-924-8175.

Designer Showhouse Event: Decorating seminars, designer showrooms; 10 a.m.–4 p.m. Saturday, noon–5 p.m. Sunday; Design Center of the Americas, 1855 Griffin Rd., DANIA BEACH; $15 a day, $25 for both days; part of the proceeds benefit Habitat for Humanity; free consultations available by appointment; 954-920-7997.

Upper Williamsburg, Brooklyn, N.Y.: Reunion of former residents; March 11 at Crystal Lake Country Club, POMPANO BEACH; 954-430-9066, 954-722-0750.

Vencor Hospital Auxiliary: Needs volunteers for the gift shop, information desk, other departments; four hours one day a week or more; 954-920-9000, ext. 3284.

LET US KNOW

Here an item to submit to the For Your Information column or any of The Herald's other calendar listings? Send it to:

Things to Do
The Herald
3225 Hollywood Blvd.
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When sending information about an event, please include your name and a telephone number where you can be reached during the day. We'll see that it finds its way to the appropriate section.

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Minority-owned businesses get financial advice

By GIL HOFFMAN
Herald Writer

The Broward Alliance, the county's economic development council, has a lofty goal: creating 33,000 new jobs in Broward County over the next five years.

To accomplish that goal, alliance president Michael Langley says the gap must be bridged between the large, corporate, mainstream business community and small businesses that struggle for every dollar.

Langley pointed out that the great majority of the nearly 750,000 jobs in Broward County are in small businesses.

"We need to focus on meeting the needs of small, minority and women business owners to become totally successful as a regional economy in South Florida," Langley said.

To that end, the alliance organized the Minority Business Mainstream Summit Monday at the Airport Hilton in Dania Beach. More than 80 minority business owners attended the summit, which featured lectures on marketing, technology, networking, raising capital and forming partnerships.

Vince Johnson, the alliance's director of minority business development, said the purpose of the summit was to hone the business skills of minority and women business owners to make them more competitive, to help them run their businesses more efficiently and to allow them to network among themselves.

The conference's keynote speakers and participants about new developments in her industry and to make new clients by networking with small-business owners. Her company, DAR Business Services of Plantation, secured $1.7 million in loans for minority business owners in 1998, averaging $100,000 each.

Business owners who attended a session on using technology in their business got practical advice. Ken Granderson, president of Inner-City Software, told owners that advertising a one-page Web site that doesn't offer any services is useless and possibly bad for business.

Gerald Wilcox, owner of Adpro Specialties in Lauderhill, which distributes printed advertising and promotional products, took the advice to heart. He's going to post a catalog of his services on his Web site, something he said he'd been meaning to do for a while.

"These kinds of things recharge you, re-energize you, and help you color outside the box," Wilcox said after listening to Granderson. "As a business owner, you have to be innovative."

'NET GAINS: Ken Granderson offered hints on effective Web-site presentation.

Photos by WALTER MICHOT / Herald Staff

GOOD IDEAS: Consultant Fred Rasheed was summit keynote speaker.

speaker, minority business consultant Fred Rasheed, said business owners have to be prepared to deal with four critical business trends in 1999: the increasingly global nature of the economy; the use of e-commerce (using the Internet to do business); the Y2K computer bug; and a reduction in the federal spending on goods and services.

Denise Ramirez, a small-business loan specialist said she attended the summit to learn from

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